

Where the need for a temporary speed limit occurs part way into a worksite, the temporary speed zone must be started at that point rather than the start of the worksite. For example, the short term need to localise a speed limit and accommodate workers on foot less than 1.2 m clear of a traffic. More than one localised speed zone is permitted within one worksite if the minimum distance between them is equal to the length of zone for the higher speed limit shown in Table 5.5.

Temporary speed zones that result in different speed limits for each direction of travel at a particular location (offset speed zones) may be used in the following conditions:

- on divided roads where works affect road users on one side of the median only
- on multilane undivided two-way roads that meet all of the following:
 - more than one lane in the same direction of travel past the worksite
 - works in the left lane and/or clear of the road
 - conditions necessitating the temporary speed limit are confined to one direction of travel only
 - there are no intersections or property access requirements within the temporary speed zone.
- where a speed buffer zone is provided. For example, advance warning of a 60 km/h speed limit is provided in an 80 km/h buffer zone, when the original speed was 100 km/h. This buffer zone speed limit is not needed for road users leaving the temporary speed zone because the buffer does not apply to the opposite direction of travel. The offset speed zone will only apply in the speed zone buffer area and not the whole worksite.

Temporary speed zones are communicated clearly to road users with the following traffic control devices in order for them to recognise the need to adjust their speed:

- a Speed Limit AHEAD sign must be located a distance double the speed in advance of the Speed Restriction sign and must be located on the left-hand side of the road and should be duplicated (placed on both sides of the roadway) where practicable on roads with an annual average daily traffic (total vehicle count in both directions of travel per day) of over 500 vehicles per day. Refer to Table 5.6 – *Methods for reducing speed limit* for the use of the Speed Limit AHEAD sign
- a Supplementary ROAD WORK and Speed Restriction sign or a Speed Restriction sign in a multi message panel at the start of temporary speed zone as follows:
 - Speed Restriction signs must be placed on the left-hand side of the road at the start of a temporary speed zone (either a speed reduction or speed increase).